

Games drive 3D

Analysts claim that 3D games will drive the demand for 3D displays and glasses. Evidently they feel that 3D movies are not a sufficient motivator

Galaxy's single slot GTX 470

Galaxy has just done the impossible – they've built a GTX 470 graphic card with a single slot cooler – no mean feat considering Fermi's heat generation

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The HDTV market is at a most interesting juncture right now. As with any in-demand consumer product, manufacturers are constantly upping the ante by churning out more and more products to meet the ever burgeoning demand. Sadly, along with popularity comes the deceit, the subterfuge and the pertinent omissions. It's often a matter of quantity over quality. We see the market flooded with options, in the hope that one or the other will hook you. For this reason, we see several parallel product lines, often with little difference in the underlying technology save for a few

tweaks, and a few tertiary features. This is a tried and tested formula: add a different shape and stand, add a few lights and slightly larger speaker enclosures, and voila – a new, costlier product line is born. Increments to performance, if any, are mostly minimal. That's not to say there are no improvements in HDTV and allied technology – quite the contrary – there is a lot of research going on, even as you're reading this! It's just that you need to wade through hype a mile wide and decide between reality and purple prose – not the easiest thing to do.

Amidst all this, there's one thing we unanimously agree on – HDTV's are both the present and the future. As higher resolution, (read high-definition),

content slowly gains popularity, whether it is cable TV or Blu-Ray content, the applications for a large flat screen are many. Connect it to your Blu-Ray player, your Xbox 360 or PS3 and even your PC. The sheer realism of watching movies on a large screen that dominates most of your field of view is something that simply cannot be replicated by smaller displays, and it has to be experienced to be believed. So plonk into your couch, grab a bowl of popcorn and fire up that gigantic beauty while we dim the lights. Wait! – Before we get ahead of ourselves, we're only dimming the lights for our calibration purposes; you need to buy an HDTV first. Choose from amongst these beauties...

LG 47LH50YR

Large and lovely

A very handsome looking display, although it doesn't have the fancy stand and sleekness of its LED-backlit siblings, it's built of pretty sturdy materials and a piano-black finish that although common, is also hard to goof up. High quality plastic is used everywhere, and the rear is also pretty thick. The thick neck of the stand suits its bulk, and at 47-inches it's pretty large, noticeably larger than a 42-inch display. The swivel action on the stand is slick. The power indicator is sweet, and unobtrusive, yet catchy. A red LED is placed behind a wide contoured transparent strip of fibre to give a nice glow effect. This turns to blue when powered on. The menu

Redefined Realism

HDTVs are getting bigger, better and cheaper by the month. There are many models and brands to choose from. We test a few of the more value-for-money offerings available.

